

Forecasts and Portfolio

Guide 5 of 6

TL;DR

Forecasts is the prediction-market surface; Portfolio is the equities-side companion. Both are read-only by default. Live trading is guarded by eight successive human gates: every gate is explicit, every gate is manual, and the system refuses to advance past any gate it does not see authorized. This guide explains paper vs. live, the eight-gate contract, and the per-bet operator confirmation flow.

You will need

- A signed-in Codex session as an operator.
- For paper trading: the scheduler running.
- For live trading: real funds, real credentials, and the environment variables in `docs/operations/Forecasts_Portfolio_Setup.md`. Do not proceed past paper mode without reading that document and the founder-alpha runbook end to end.

This guide does NOT cover

- Credential storage; covered authoritatively in `docs/operations/Forecasts_Portfolio_Setup.md`.
- Scheduler ops; see `docs/operations/Forecasts_Scheduler.md`.
- The decision contract; see `docs/architecture/Algorithmized_Decision_Making.md`.
- The kill switch, deletion, replication outreach — Guide 6.

1 What Forecasts and Portfolio are

Forecasts (`/forecasts`) is a grid of prediction-market opportunities. Each card is one `ForecastPrediction` row. A row is publicly visible iff `liveAuthorizedAt IS NOT NULL` and `status IN ('OPEN', 'RESOLVED')`.

Portfolio (`/forecasts/portfolio` and the dashboard rail) is the live and paper position view: open positions, realized PnL, exchange balances, exposure caps.

[screenshot `screenshots/05_forecasts_grid.png` not yet captured — The Forecasts grid, with one open prediction in detail view.]

2 Paper vs. live

The system has two trading modes, controlled by a single env flag:

- **Paper.** The default. The scheduler ingests markets, scores them, and writes bets to a paper-mode ledger. No order ever reaches an exchange. Paper mode is safe to run with production

credentials configured — the live-trading flag is the only thing that ever lets the system call `submit_live_bet`.

- **Live.** Requires `FORECASTS_LIVE_TRADING_ENABLED=true` *plus* the seven other gates below. Real funds move.

3 The eight-gate safety contract

The contract is taken verbatim from the founder-alpha runbook (`docs/operations/Forecasts_Founder_Alpha_Runbook.md §0`). Each gate is a separate human action; no gate auto-promotes the next.

1. **Exchange credentials configured.** Polymarket and/or Kalshi env vars present on the API and scheduler processes. See `Forecasts_Portfolio_Setup.md`.
2. **Scheduler ingesting & monitoring.** The forecasts worker container is running and writing recent rows. Absence of fresh rows blocks every downstream step.
3. **Paper mode validated.** Paper bets have been written, scored, and reconciled for long enough that you trust the decision pipeline.
4. **Risk caps configured.** `FORECASTS_MAX_STAKE_USD` and `FORECASTS_MAX_DAILY_LOSS_USD` are set to numbers you are willing to lose. The submitter checks both on every bet.
5. **Master live flag.** `FORECASTS_LIVE_TRADING_ENABLED=true`. Without this, no other authorization counts.
6. **Per-prediction live authorization.** The operator UI sets `liveAuthorizedAt` on the specific `ForecastPrediction` row. A row that is live-eligible in principle but not yet authorized is still paper-only.
7. **Per-bet live confirmation.** For each individual bet, the operator clicks confirm. The system refuses to submit without it.
8. **Kill switch clear at submit time.** The submitter re-checks the kill switch immediately before placing the order. If the kill switch flipped between confirmation and submission, the bet is dropped.

If any gate fails, every later gate refuses. The staircase is the control surface.

[screenshot `screenshots/05_forecasts_authorization.png` not yet captured — The per-bet confirmation modal: live amount, gate state, and the explicit human-confirmation click target.]

4 The per-bet operator confirmation flow

Day-to-day, gates 1–5 are configured once and stay configured. The gates a founder sees on most bets are gates 6, 7, and 8.

1. Open the forecast row in **Forecasts**.
2. Click **Authorize for live trading** if the row is not yet authorized. The system records `liveAuthorizedAt` with the actor and timestamp. This is gate 6.
3. For each proposed bet, the row shows: amount, side, edge estimate, model confidence, current price. Click **Confirm live bet**. This is gate 7.

4. The submitter re-evaluates the kill switch (FORECASTS_KILL_SWITCH) in the same request that places the order. This is gate 8. You do not click anything for gate 8 except to ensure the kill switch is not set.

5 The Portfolio surface

Portfolio shows: open positions, realized PnL by exchange and overall, exposure relative to the configured caps, and recent fills. It is the place to verify the daily loss cap is not about to trip, and to spot stuck or unfilled orders.

[screenshot screenshots/05_portfolio_summary.png not yet captured — The Portfolio summary card on the founder dashboard.]

The portfolio surface is read-only with respect to live trading. You cannot place a bet from the portfolio view — bets are placed from the per-forecast card, where the gating UI lives.

Preview — partially shipped

The portfolio's equities sub-surface (real-money equity orders) is gated identically to the prediction-market surface but currently ships in read-only mode for live accounts. The eight gates are wired in; the equity submitter is staged behind an additional environment flag. See docs/operations/Forecasts_Founder_Alpha_Runbook.md §8 for the live-equity status.

6 What can go wrong

- **A bet is suggested but cannot be authorized.** Almost always a missing earlier gate. Look at the gate ribbon on the forecast card — it shows which gate is currently red.
- **The kill switch trips mid-session.** The submitter refuses new orders. Open positions are not auto-closed; you close them manually if you want to. The kill switch path is documented in Guide 6.
- **Daily loss cap exceeded.** The submitter refuses new orders for the rest of the day, even if all eight gates are otherwise green. Reset is by the calendar day, not by operator action.
- **An exchange API returns an error.** The system retries with bounded backoff. Persistent errors are surfaced on the portfolio card; you can pause ingestion or trading from **ops**.

7 Where the docs are

- docs/operations/Forecasts_Founder_Alpha_Runbook.md — the single page to keep open during the first live session.
- docs/operations/Forecasts_Portfolio_Setup.md — credential surface; the negative rules around key material.
- docs/operations/Forecasts_Scheduler.md — worker loops.
- docs/architecture/Algorithmized_Decision_Making.md — decision contract; how the gates and edge estimate compose.

Where to read next

Continue with [Guide 6 — Operator Console](#) for the founder-only surfaces of last resort: the kill switch, live authorization revocation, deletion requests, and replication outreach drafts.